



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 26

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Reading & Using Safety Data Sheets (SDS)

OVERVIEW:

The Safety Data Sheet is the primary source of hazard information for every chemical product used on the job. Under OSHA's Hazard Communication Standard, every chemical product must have an SDS available to all workers who use or may be exposed to it. Knowing how to read an SDS is not optional — it is a

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. An SDS has 16 standardized sections, and you do not need to read all of them every time. The sections you need most frequently are Section 2 — Hazard Identification, which tells you what is dangerous about the product; Section 4 — First Aid Measures, which tells you what to do if someone is exposed; Section 7 — Handling and Storage, which tells you safe practices and incompatibilities;
2. Section 8 of the SDS gives you the exposure limits for the chemical — the OSHA Permissible Exposure Limit and the ACGIH Threshold Limit Value — and specifies the required respiratory protection, gloves, and eye protection. If the SDS says a product requires an organic vapor respirator and you are using an N95 dust mask, you are not adequately protected. The SDS is the authority on PPE
3. You have the legal right to access the SDS for every chemical product you work with. Your employer is required to maintain a complete SDS library and make it accessible during your working hours. If you ask for an SDS and your supervisor cannot produce it, that chemical should not be in use. You have the right to refuse to use a chemical product for which no SDS is available.
4. SDSs must be reviewed when you are using a product for the first time, when a product changes formulation, and periodically as a refresher. Products that look the same — same brand, same color code — can change their chemical formulation between batches. The date on the SDS tells you when it was last updated. If your SDS is more than a few years old, request a current version from the

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Where are the SDS sheets for all products currently in use on this job stored, and can you show me?
Q2: Pick one product we are using right now and walk through what Section 8 tells us about required PPE.

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- SDS must be accessible to all workers — know exactly where they are stored
- Section 2 lists all hazards; Section 8 provides full PPE requirements
- Section 4 provides first aid measures — review before an emergency occurs
- Section 7 gives safe handling and storage requirements for each product
- If a product has no SDS available, do not use it until one is obtained

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 26

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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